

GENDER

Bala Rao Vs. Munish Tahiliani



BENDERS

Spot The Naught

This time round, it was a quiz of sorts: spot two incorrect statements from amongst five.

(1) DOS was the first GUI from Microsoft; (2) "URL" is related to the Internet; (3) Linux is an OS; (4) "IBM" stands for Informational Business Machines; (5) "Browsing" is the same as surfing. OK, we know you know (1) and (4) are wrong, and we also know you know we should have called it "GNU/Linux." But what about Bala and Munish?



"But I know very little about computers," Bala whined. We told her she didn't need to know too much, and that sort of reassured her. So was DOS a GUI? Some thought later, she nodded. Ouch! About "URL," she was a lot quicker. Linux was certainly an OS, and the "I" in IBM was not "Informational." Cool. Surprisingly, the fifth got Bala thinking, and worse, she decided there was some kind of subtle difference between browsing and surfing! So that's a 3 out of 5... as good as guesswork, and we were left hoping Munish would do better.

Munish Tahiliani was actually eager to take the test, but we soon figured he wasn't a *Digit* reader: the first question had him stumped. But he rightly pronounced DOS a non-GUI, and was quicker at the second. "Is Linux an OS" elicited a skyward look from him, and we had to gnash our teeth when he said it wasn't. "IBM" for him was guesswork. Wrong guesswork. And finally, he did figure browsing and surfing were the same, so that was again 3 out of 5. When will people learn to start reading *Digit* and stop having to guess?



fears that the lifting of the ban would be temporary. However, it wasn't clear if the site was inaccessible due to technical problems or because government censors had re-blocked it.

Still, is Big Brother on the way to becoming friendlier? Does the move mean that Chinese Internet users will eventually be able to surf the free Net the way the rest of us do? Did all that China-bashing really work? Hardly. China's never been a nation that cared about the international community's opinion of it, and this time it's no different. Says Julien Pain, who runs the Internet Freedom Desk at Reporters Without Borders, the move

has more to do with giving Chinese users access to information that could help give them a competitive edge in business, and has nothing to do with looking better in the eyes of the world. So it's world domination they're after; now *that* sounds more like China.

LEGAL EAGLE DEPT.

Adobe To Go After Microsoft

Everyone's suing everyone else. We're pretty sure that you'll be seeing at least one such

story in every issue; in the ring this time are two of the world's biggest software companies. Adobe will be watching Vista's end-January release more closely than anyone else, more than hinting at the possibility of an upcoming suit against M-Dollar for shutting out rivals.

The uproar is over the XML Paper Specification (XPS), which Windows Vista and Office 2007 support by default. XPS is another document format built for easy transportation—the same idea that powers Adobe's largely ubiquitous Portable Document Format (PDF). When Adobe first went crying to approached the European Commission (EC) over antitrust concerns, Microsoft responded by having XPS converted to a standard compliant with open source licenses, freeing *anyone* to bundle the format. MS—1, Adobe—0.

Adobe will continue to work with the EC to determine whether Microsoft's decision to bundle the format is an abuse of its top dog position in the office productivity market.

The EC has been after Microsoft for ages over the embarrassment of features bundled in Vista, insisting that they shut out competing products and hence violate antitrust laws. Less than two months before the launch, Vista still hasn't got the green signal from the EC, but will be launching on time nevertheless, thanks to some "constructive dialogue" over the issues that so concern us all.

You'd think that Adobe wouldn't have anything to worry about, what with the PDF format's humungous popularity, but we see their concerns—while Microsoft can't be accused of being the first to bring out a concept, their near-inexhaustible resources and dogged persistence have often brought the best to their knees.

A bit of trivia: Microsoft was going to bundle PDF support with Office 2007 as well, but extensive bickering with Adobe over licensing the technology made them drop those plans mighty quick.

BLINK AND IT'S GONE

PS3 Sells Out In Minutes

Even if you live under a rock, chances are that someone's lifted it long enough to tell you about the Sony PlayStation 3. The insanely hyped and long delayed console finally hit Japan and US markets mid-November, with shoppers queuing up outside stores at least two days in advance braving rain and aching feet. And then there is the unfortunate soul who was shot at 3 a.m. while in the line for the console—because he refused to part with his well-earmarked dough.

The last console vanished from the last shelf just minutes after shutters opened, leaving many empty hands and souls. The frenzy

Buzzword
of the MONTH

Crysis

Crysis, a First Person Shooter game has been long awaited by the lovers of *Far Cry*, and the Web is agog with screenshots, discussion, and general speculation! The game, like many others, is based on science fiction (aliens and stuff). *Crysis* uses the CryEngine 2 graphics engine (*Far Cry* uses the CryEngine). CryEngine 2 is the first engine that uses DirectX 10, though *Crysis* can run both on DX9 and DX10. For all you gamers who know what it all

means, *Crysis* uses dynamic day/night cycles, sunrays and diffuse transmission, real-time soft shadows, soft particles, interactive/destructible environments, volumetric clouds, and more! (www.crysis-online.com)

Crysis adds to the thrill by making use of some fascinating weapons. The facial expressions of the characters sync well with their voices. The AI has been claimed to take the game to a different level.